Wildfire Evacuation Checklist

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/what-to-do-during-a-wildfire/, which lists its sources (CAL FIRE and American Red Cross guidance). Updated November 12, 2026.

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

BugOut
Offline survival guide for iPhone

If you have time before you leave

- [ ] Close all windows and doors, but leave them unlocked
- [ ] Leave lights on so firefighters can see your house in smoke
- [ ] Turn off gas at the meter and pilot lights
- [ ] Turn off the air conditioning
- [ ] Take down flammable curtains; close metal shutters
- [ ] Move furniture to the middle of rooms, away from windows and doors
- [ ] Bring in patio furniture, doormats and trash cans; shut off propane tanks
- [ ] Connect garden hoses and fill buckets, but don't leave sprinklers running
- [ ] Load your go bag, and keep pets close

If you're trapped by a wildfire

Where	What to do
In a car	Stay calm. Park somewhere clear of vegetation. Close all windows and vents. Cover yourself with a wool blanket or jacket, lie on the floor and call 911.
At home	Stay calm and gather everyone. Call 911. Fill sinks and tubs with cold water. Keep doors and windows closed but unlocked. Stay inside, away from outside walls and windows.
On foot	Stay calm. Get to a clear area, such as a ditch or flat ground with little to burn. Lie face down, cover your body and call 911.

Wildfire go checklist

- [ ] A go bag for each person with 3 days of supplies
- [ ] A month of medicines
- [ ] Copies of IDs, insurance and medical records
- [ ] Phone chargers and a backup battery
- [ ] N95 respirators
- [ ] A wool blanket in the car
- [ ] Pet carriers, leashes and food
- [ ] Two evacuation routes, and a place to stay
- [ ] Full gas tank